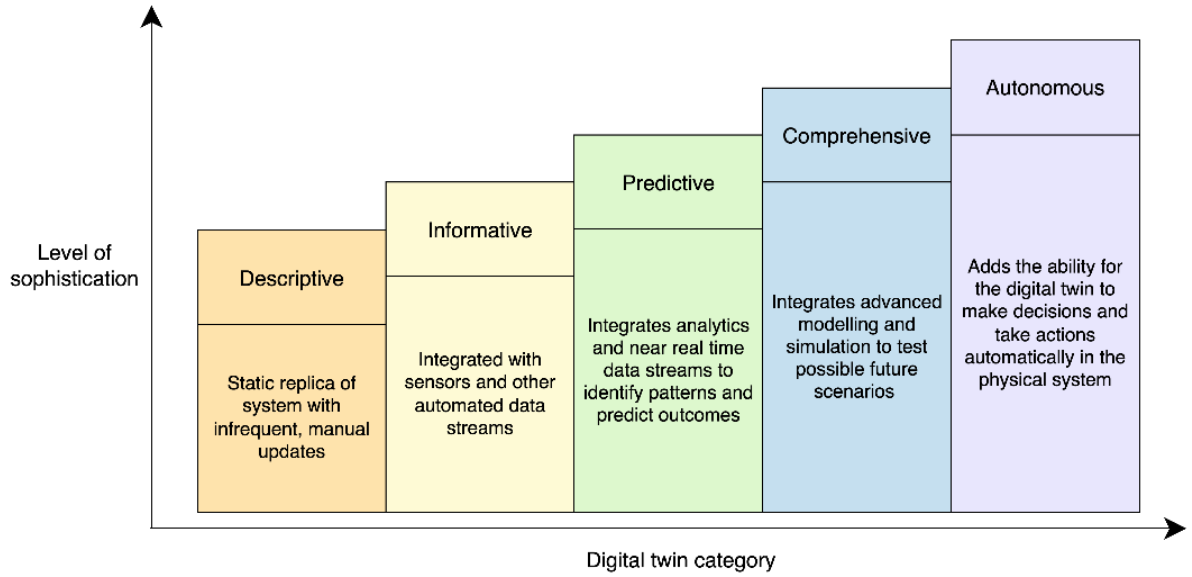


Figure 1.2 The five categories of digital twin.

1.3.1 Descriptive digital twin

At the most basic level is the *descriptive digital twin*. This twin provides a reasonably static digital representation of a physical object or system, without making real-time predictions or responding to changes. This representation might be a simple engineering diagram or a fully rendered 3D visualization.

REAL WORLD EXAMPLE: ONLINE MAPS

A familiar example of a descriptive digital twin is Google Maps. What you see when you use this product is a digital model of real-world cities containing roads, buildings, and parks and generated from cartographic maps, satellite imagery and other sources, as shown in figure 1.3.